

Poetry Submission

River Styx: November 15th, 2024

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Absolve

come down at dusk
when the sea breathes
so gently it glistens
like oil in the amber light
while the sun sets
behind the last snowy patch
on the mountain above
where the bard
and prophet Orpheus
made his home

come down and wade
into the water
to be baptized again
to let the salt cure
the regret of lost days
and absolve yourself
of the sin of forgetting
your way home

summer by summer
the seabed has changed
stones of gray chambray
or black with white veins
and wide plots of seaweed
stained like dark coffee
shift with the churning tides

tread your path with care
across the slick stones
and over the seaweed plots
out into the great expanse
then float on your back until
it all starts to feel familiar
the silence underneath
the smell of salt and sand

wait for the moon to rise
and listen as whispered
notes of forgiveness
roll down like pebbles
from the mountain tomb
of Orpheus and his lyre
saying

*return home
and take up the tune*

Begin Again

light breaks the blueberry sky
a new day opens
with a quiet overture

i take my coffee
by the window

the light starts to sing
and the wet grass shimmers
like a million strands of tinsel
each blade like a slender saint
robed in green and waiting
for the weight of dewdrops
that formed in the night
to dissolve in the warmth
of morning

in this sweet aloneness
i let my worries condense
clear as drops of dew
and faithfully worship
the dappled light of morning

i whisper a prayer
to every greenly saint
that dewdrops might dissolve
that i might begin again

The Conversation

palms rustle at daybreak
and tiny songbirds
greet and scatter

the breeze carries
a wordless exchange
between the ocean
and the mountains

all i do is
listen

a moment of stillness
is my silent prayer
to be unburdened
by words

to receive the conversation
without hopes or expectations